

04_transfer_learning_with_resnet

October 4, 2025

```
[2]: import os
      # Check if the notebook is running on Google Colab
      colab = False
      if 'COLAB_GPU' in os.environ:
          colab = True
          # Running on Google Colab; install loguru
          !pip install mads_datasets mltrainer loguru
      else:
          # Not running on Google Colab; you might be on a local setup
          print("Not running on Google Colab. Ensure dependencies are installed as_
↳needed.")
```

Not running on Google Colab. Ensure dependencies are installed as needed.

```
[3]: from pathlib import Path
      from loguru import logger
      import torch
      import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
```

Let's revisit the flowers dataset from the first lesson

```
[4]: from mads_datasets import DatasetFactoryProvider, DatasetType

      flowersfactory = DatasetFactoryProvider.create_factory(DatasetType.FLOWERS)
      streamers = flowersfactory.create_datastreamer(batchsize=32)
```

```
2025-10-04 19:51:44.600 | INFO      |
mads_datasets.base:download_data:121 - Folder
```

already exists at /Users/nickreinders/.cache/mads_datasets/flowers

We have just about 3000 images. To get more out of our data, we will use a technique called ‘data augmentation’. When an image is flipped, or cropped, we get a different image, preventing the model to overfit on the quirks of this small dataset. We will also normalize the images to the mean and standard deviation used when training resnet; this is not strictly necessary, but should make it a bit easier for the model to work with our images.

```
[5]: from torchvision import transforms
      data_transforms = {
          'train': transforms.Compose([
```

```

        transforms.RandomResizedCrop(224),
        transforms.RandomHorizontalFlip(),
        transforms.Normalize([0.485, 0.456, 0.406], [0.229, 0.224, 0.225])
    ]),
    'val': transforms.Compose([
        transforms.Resize(256),
        transforms.CenterCrop(224),
        transforms.Normalize([0.485, 0.456, 0.406], [0.229, 0.224, 0.225])
    ]),
}

```

Because we want to crop the images, lets make our images during preprocessing a bit bigger, so we actually have something to crop:

```
[6]: flowersfactory.settings
```

```

[6]: dataset_url: https://storage.googleapis.com/download.tensorflow.org/example_images/flower_photos.tgz
    filename: flowers.tgz
    name: flowers
    unzip: True
    formats: [<FileTypes.JPG: '.jpg']
    digest: 6f87fb78e9cc9ab41eff2015b380011d
    trainfrac: 0.8
    img_size: (224, 224)

```

```
[7]: flowersfactory.settings.img_size = (500, 500)
```

With this modification of the settings, we can create the dataset. We can see our images are actually 500x500 pixels now.

The transformations are just a function; we can input the img and get a transformed image out. Let try that, and visualise the result:

PS: if you dont have enough RAM on colab (eg 12GB), the cell below might crash your notebook (because it recreates the dataset); the first cell in this notebook has set the value of 'colab' to True if you are on colab, to avoid this issue.

```

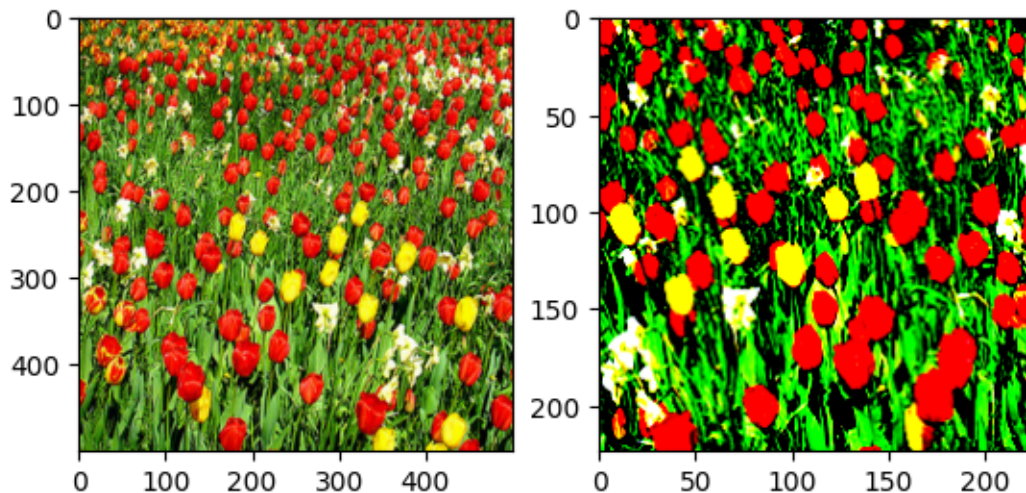
[8]: if not colab:
    datasets = flowersfactory.create_dataset()
    traindataset = datasets["train"]
    img, lab = traindataset[0]
    logger.info(f"original shape: {img.shape}")
    # original shape: torch.Size([3, 500, 500])
    transformed_img = data_transforms["train"](img)
    logger.info(f"transformed shape: {transformed_img.shape}")
    # transformed shape: torch.Size([3, 224, 224])

    fig, ax = plt.subplots(1, 2)

```

```
ax[0].imshow(img.numpy().transpose(1, 2, 0))
ax[1].imshow(transformed_img.numpy().transpose(1, 2, 0))
```

```
2025-10-04 19:51:51.228 | INFO      |
mads_datasets.base:download_data:121 - Folder
already exists at /Users/nickreinders/.cache/mads_datasets/flowers
2025-10-04 19:52:11.991 | INFO      |
__main__:<module>:5 - original shape:
torch.Size([3, 500, 500])
2025-10-04 19:52:12.269 | INFO      |
__main__:<module>:8 - transformed shape:
torch.Size([3, 224, 224])
Clipping input data to the valid range for imshow with RGB data ([0..1] for
floats or [0..255] for integers). Got range [-2.1147764..2.6115859].
```



Instead of using the BasePreprocessor, we will squeeze in the transformer. Lets make that:

```
[9]: class AugmentPreprocessor():
      def __init__(self, transform):
          self.transform = transform
      def __call__(self, batch: list[tuple]) -> tuple[torch.Tensor, torch.Tensor]:
          X, y = zip(*batch)
          X = [self.transform(x) for x in X]
          return torch.stack(X), torch.stack(y)
```

Now we can create an separate preprocessor for train and validation:

```
[10]: trainprocessor= AugmentPreprocessor(data_transforms["train"])
      validprocessor = AugmentPreprocessor(data_transforms["val"])
```

And add that as the preprocessor for train and validation streamers. We do it like this because by default we can only provide a single preprocessor for both training and validation.

```
[11]: train = streamers["train"]
      valid = streamers["valid"]
      train.preprocessor = trainprocessor
      valid.preprocessor = validprocessor
      trainstreamer = train.stream()
      validstreamer = valid.stream()
```

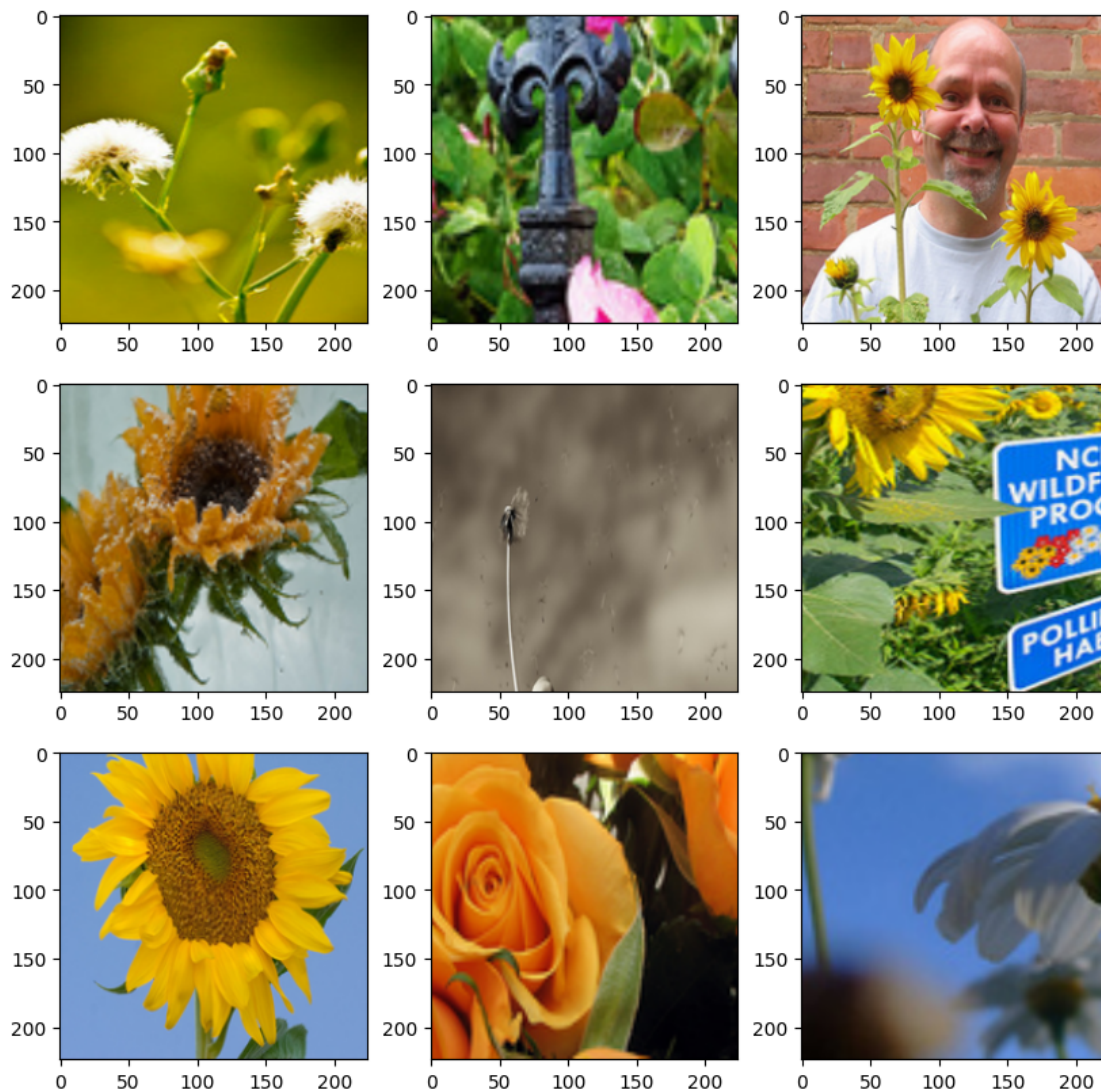
Let's confirm this works:

```
[12]: X, y = next(trainstreamer)
      X.shape, y.shape
```

```
[12]: (torch.Size([32, 3, 224, 224]), torch.Size([32]))
```

And lets visualise a random batch of images

```
[13]: import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
      import numpy as np
      img = X.permute(0, 2, 3, 1).numpy()
      mean = np.array([0.485, 0.456, 0.406])
      std = np.array([0.229, 0.224, 0.225])
      img = std * img + mean
      img = np.clip(img, 0, 1)
      fig, axs = plt.subplots(3, 3, figsize=(10,10))
      axs = axs.ravel()
      for i in range(9):
          axs[i].imshow(img[i])
```



Instead of building our own resnet, we will just download a pretrained version. This saves us many hours of training.

```
[14]: import torchvision
      from torchvision.models import resnet18, ResNet18_Weights
      resnet = torchvision.models.resnet18(weights=ResNet18_Weights.DEFAULT)
```

```
[15]: ResNet18_Weights.DEFAULT
```

```
[15]: ResNet18_Weights.IMAGENET1K_V1
```

```
[16]: yhat = resnet(X)
      yhat.shape
```

```
[16]: torch.Size([32, 1000])
```

However, the resnet is trained for 1000 classes. We have just 5...

We will swap the last layer and retrain the model.

First, we freeze all pretrained layers:

```
[17]: for name, param in resnet.named_parameters():  
      param.requires_grad = False
```

If you study the resnet implementation on [github](#) you can see that the last layer is named `.fc`, like this:

```
self.fc = nn.Linear(512 * block.expansion, num_classes)
```

This is a Linear layer, mapping from `512 * block.expansion` to `num_classes`.

so we will swap that for our own. To do so we need to figure out how many features go into the `.fc` layer. We can retrieve the incoming amount of features for the current `.fc` with `.in_features`

```
[18]: print(type(resnet.fc))  
in_features = resnet.fc.in_features  
in_features
```

```
<class 'torch.nn.modules.linear.Linear'>
```

```
[18]: 512
```

Let's swap that layer with a minimal network. Sometimes just a linear layer is enough, sometimes you want to add two layers and some dropout. Play around to see the difference!

```
[19]: import torch.nn as nn  
  
resnet.fc = nn.Sequential(  
    nn.Linear(in_features, 5)  
    #nn.Linear(in_features, 128), nn.ReLU(), nn.Dropout(0.1), nn.Linear(128, 5)  
)
```

```
[20]: yhat = resnet(X)  
yhat.shape
```

```
[20]: torch.Size([32, 5])
```

So, we have a fully trained resnet, but we added two layers at the end that transforms everything into 5 classes. These layers are random, so we need to train them for some epochs

```
[21]: from mltrainer import metrics  
accuracy = metrics.Accuracy()
```

This will take some time to train (about 4 min per epoch), you could scale down to amount of trainsteps to speed things up.

You will start with a fairly high learning rate (0.01), and if the learning stops, after patience epochs the learning rate gets halved.

```
[22]: len(train), len(valid)
```

```
[22]: (91, 22)
```

```
[23]: if torch.backends.mps.is_available() and torch.backends.mps.is_built():
        device = torch.device("mps")
    elif torch.cuda.is_available():
        device = torch.device("cuda")
    else:
        device = "cpu"
        logger.warning("This model will take 15-20 minutes on CPU. Consider using_
↪accelaration, eg with google colab (see button on top of the page)")
    logger.info(f"Using {device}")
```

```
2025-10-04 19:52:18.115 | INFO      |
__main__:<module>:8 - Using mps
```

We are going to use SGD as optimizer and a stepLR as scheduler.

```
[24]: from torch import optim
        optimizer = optim.SGD
        scheduler = optim.lr_scheduler.StepLR
```

To make this actually learn enough, you should increase the epochs to about 30.

```
[25]: from mltrainer import Trainer, TrainerSettings, ReportTypes

        settings = TrainerSettings(
            epochs=3,
            metrics=[accuracy],
            logdir="modellogs/flowers",
            train_steps=len(train),
            valid_steps=len(valid),
            reporttypes=[ReportTypes.TENSORBOARD],
            optimizer_kwargs= {'lr': 0.1, 'weight_decay': 1e-05, 'momentum': 0.9},
            scheduler_kwargs= {'step_size' : 10, 'gamma' : 0.1},
            earlystop_kwargs= None,
        )
        settings
```

```
[25]: epochs: 3
        metrics: [Accuracy]
        logdir: modellogs/flowers
        train_steps: 91
        valid_steps: 22
        reporttypes: [<ReportTypes.TENSORBOARD: 'TENSORBOARD'>]
```



```
optimizer_kwargs: {'lr': 0.1, 'weight_decay': 1e-05, 'momentum': 0.9}
scheduler_kwargs: {'step_size': 10, 'gamma': 0.1}
earlystop_kwargs: None
```

```
[26]: trainer = Trainer(
    model=resnet,
    settings=settings,
    loss_fn=nn.CrossEntropyLoss(),
    optimizer=optimizer,
    traindataloader=trainstreamer,
    validdataloader=validstreamer,
    scheduler=scheduler,
    device=device,
)
```

```
2025-10-04 19:52:18.164 | INFO      |
mltrainer.trainer:dir_add_timestamp:24 - Logging
to modellogs/flowers/20251004-195218
```

```
[27]: # note: this will be very slow without acceleration!
trainer.loop()
```

```
100%|      | 91/91 [00:20<00:00,  4.46it/s]
2025-10-04 19:52:42.092 | INFO      |
mltrainer.trainer:report:209 - Epoch 0 train

4.0458 test 1.6661 metric ['0.8736']
100%|      | 91/91 [00:11<00:00,  8.14it/s]
2025-10-04 19:52:55.201 | INFO      |
mltrainer.trainer:report:209 - Epoch 1 train

3.5158 test 4.6391 metric ['0.7756']
100%|      | 91/91 [00:09<00:00,  9.33it/s]
2025-10-04 19:53:06.834 | INFO      |
mltrainer.trainer:report:209 - Epoch 2 train

3.4645 test 2.1711 metric ['0.8679']
100%|      | 3/3 [00:48<00:00, 16.17s/it]
```

```
[ ]:
```